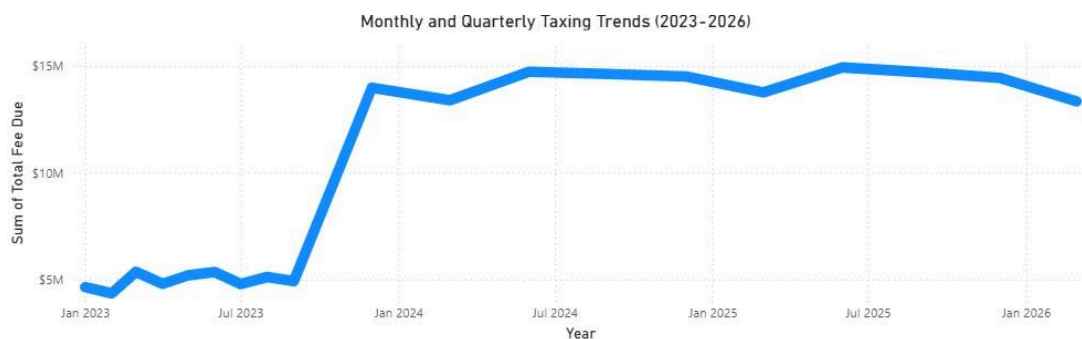


Power BI Project: Connecticut Highway Fee Program for Truckers (2023-2026)

Introduction

This dataset compiles highway fee data for drivers operating heavy, multi-unit vehicles on public roads in the State of Connecticut, covering the period January 2023 – March 2026.



The first nine records represent monthly tax filings, transitioning to quarterly filings beginning in September 2023. This shift explains the sudden increase in total fees between September and December 2023. The dataset undergoes routine cleaning and validation before analysis.

In total, there are 19 tax records—initially monthly, then quarterly—representing truckers paying highway use fees in Connecticut.

Data Column Overview

Period End Date

This column contains date values with no nulls. The dataset begins with monthly records and transitions to quarterly entries, each representing a three-month period. An Index column was added to simplify future calculations and maintain chronological order.

Total Taxpayers

Represents the combined number of in-state and out-of-state taxpayers charged the highway fee. The data type is Whole Number, formatted with a thousands separator for readability.

In-State Taxpayers

Shows the total number of Connecticut taxpayers who paid the highway fee. The data type is Whole Number, with no nulls detected. A thousands separator was added for clarity.

Out-of-State Taxpayers

Lists the total number of taxpayers from outside Connecticut who paid the highway fee. The data type is Whole Number, with no nulls. A thousands separator was added for clarity.

Total Fee Due

Displays the total fees owed at the start of each monthly or quarterly period, combining both in-state and out-of-state taxpayers. The data type is Fixed Decimal Number (float/double). A thousands separator and USD currency format were applied.

In-State Total Fee Due

Shows the total fees owed by in-state taxpayers at the start of each period. The data type is Fixed Decimal Number (float/double). A thousands separator and USD currency format were applied.

Out-of-State Total Fee Due

Represents the total fees owed by out-of-state taxpayers at the start of each period. The data type is Fixed Decimal Number (float/double). A thousands separator and USD currency format were applied.

Additional Columns for Analysis

To enrich insights and enable actionable recommendations, several calculated columns were added:

Index

Created in Power Query to maintain ordered records and simplify DAX calculations for period-to-period percent changes.

In-State Tax Average

Average tax paid per in-state taxpayer per month/quarter:

$$\text{In-State Tax Average} = \frac{\text{'export'[In-State Total Fee Due]}}{\text{'export'[In-State Taxpayers]}}$$

Out-of-State Tax Average

Average tax paid per out-of-state taxpayer:

$$\text{Out-of-State Tax Average} = \frac{\text{'export'[Out-of-State Total Fee Due]}}{\text{'export'[Out-of-State Taxpayers]}}$$

Total Tax Average

Overall average tax paid per taxpayer:

Total Tax Average =
'export'[Total Fee Due] /
'export'[Total Taxpayers]

In-State Percent Change

Percent change in total in-state taxes from the prior period:

In-State Percent Change =
VAR CurrentValue = 'export'[In-State Total Fee Due]
VAR PrevValue =
CALCULATE(
MAX('export'[In-State Total Fee Due]),
FILTER('export', 'export'[Index] = EARLIER('export'[Index]) + 1)
)
RETURN DIVIDE(CurrentValue - PrevValue, PrevValue)

Out-of-State Percent Change

Same calculation as above, substituting out-of-state values.

Total Percent Change

Overall percent change in total taxes owed.

In-State Driver Percentage: Share of total drivers from Connecticut.

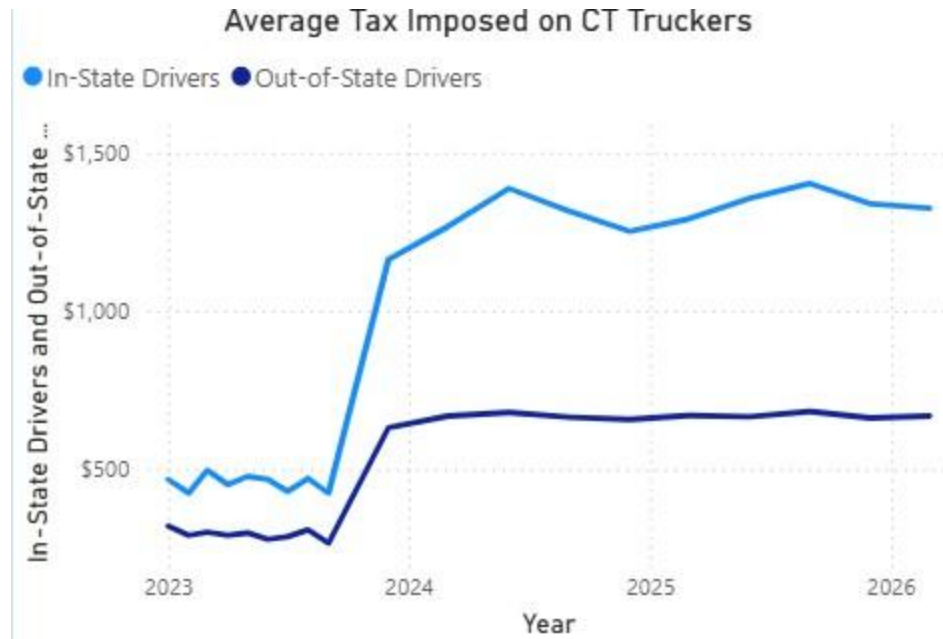
Out-of-State Driver Percentage: Share of total drivers from outside Connecticut.

In-State Percentage of Total Taxes: In-state drivers' share of total tax collected.

Out-of-State Percentage of Total Taxes: Out-of-state drivers' share of total tax collected.

Insights and Analysis

- Connecticut drivers pay more on average (\$1,100 – \$1,200) after the transition to quarterly fees, compared to \$600 for out-of-state drivers.



- Although the increase appears steep, percent changes are comparable: +176% for in-state and +185% for out-of-state taxpayers.
- The gap in tax averages reflects greater highway usage by Connecticut drivers, leading to more taxable activity.
- For local carriers, this financial strain may create frustration and operational challenges.

Recommendations for the State of Connecticut

- Consider targeted tax credits or relief programs for small in-state carriers to reduce financial strain.
- Evaluate a rate rebalance—slightly lowering in-state rates while modestly increasing out-of-state rates—to maintain revenue stability and improve fairness.
- Explore a return to monthly reporting to reduce large quarterly tax spikes, making payments more manageable for smaller businesses.